

XFMC Quick Tutorial

Version 3.52 – December 2025 Example Flight: KPDX → KSJC

Requirements

1. **X-Plane 12** (working installation)
2. **Aircraft:** x737 by Benedikt Stratmann ☐ [Download here](#) (or standard Laminar 737)
3. (Optional) **Better Pushback plugin** ☐ [Download here](#)
4. (Optional but recommended) **Little Navmap** ☐ [Download here](#)
5. **XFMC fully installed** ☐ [GitHub repository](#)

Setting Up Navdata

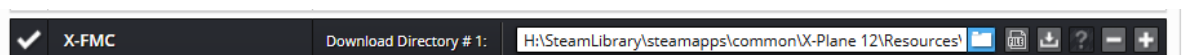
6. Navigraph Navdata (SID/STAR)

- Requires a subscription (one-time payment possible).
- [Navigraph downloads](#)
- Select **XFMC** format from Navigraph downloads.
- Extract the provided *xfmc native zip* into the folder: XFMC/Navdata.
-  x-fmc_native_2413.zip 22.769.355 19.589.209 WinRAR ZIP-archief 6-1-2025 15:25 2F73AEAA
- After unzipping, your `xfmc/navdata` folder should contain the updated files.

 Sids	10-5-2025 21:34	Bestandsmap	
 Stars	6-7-2025 19:16	Bestandsmap	
 airports.txt	17-12-2024 08:54	Tekstdocument	2.735 kB
 ats.txt	17-12-2024 08:54	Tekstdocument	11.042 kB
 cycle.json	17-12-2024 15:41	JSON File	1 kB
 cycle_info.txt	17-12-2024 10:16	Tekstdocument	1 kB
 nav aids.txt	17-12-2024 08:54	Tekstdocument	697 kB
 waypoints.txt	17-12-2024 08:54	Tekstdocument	8.444 kB

7. SimBrief Flightplan

- Register a free account at [SimBrief](#).
- Generate and download a flightplan in XFMC format.
- In the simbriefdownloader select XFMC and save it to: XFMC/Flightplans.



Creating the Flightplan

- Departure: **KPDX (Portland)**, Runway **28L**
- Destination: **KSJC (San Jose)**, Runway **30L**

Aircraft: **Boeing 737**

-  You need the **737.ini** config file for XPMC, which should be installed in

SteamLibrary > steamapps > common > X-Plane 12 > Aircraft > x737-700_v1.0_xp12 > x737-700_BB1 >			
Naam	Gewijzigd op	Type	Grootte
Airfoils	23-4-2023 14:43	Bestandsmap	
cockpit_3d	5-4-2023 17:00	Bestandsmap	
conf	30-4-2023 10:56	Bestandsmap	
fmod	1-5-2023 12:26	Bestandsmap	
liveries	25-4-2023 17:36	Bestandsmap	
objects	29-4-2023 15:01	Bestandsmap	
plugins	1-5-2023 12:24	Bestandsmap	
DS_Store	24-4-2023 20:42	DS_STORE-bestand	11 kB
x737pluginVersion.txt	10-12-2023 19:34	Tekstdocument	1 kB
737.acf	5-8-2025 20:33	ACF--bestand	1,028 kB
737.acf~	1-5-2023 11:29	ACF--bestand	1,025 kB
737.fmc	24-10-2021 21:24	FMC--bestand	11 kB
737.ini	9-12-2025 22:47	Configuratie-inste...	3 kB

the **x737** directory

Click **GENERATE** in SimBrief. The route will be saved to .../XPMC/Flightplan as:

MINNE5 HISKU Q5 HUPTU CHBLI BRIXX4

Airline **ICAO**

Flight Number **ZZZ**

Depart **KPDX**

Arrive **KSJC**

Alternate **KFAT**

Departure Time **09 Dec 2025 - 12:30**

Aircraft info

Open Airframe Editor

Aircraft Type **B738 - B737-800**

Variant or Airframe **FPR36 - PMDG FIRST CLASS 160**

Climb Profile **250/280/78**

Cruise **CI**

Cost Index **AUTO**

Descent Profile **78/280/250**

ATC Callsign **FPR36**

More Options

Selections

Outdated AIRAC

Save Defaults

OFF Layout **LIDO**

AIRAC Cycle **AIRAC 2403 - 21Mar24 to 17Apr24**

Detailed Navlog ☒

ETOPS Planning ☒

Plan Stepclimbs ☒

Runway Analysis ☒

Include NOTAMS ☒

FIR NOTAMS ☒

Units **Kilograms**

Flight Maps **Detailed**

Taxi Out / In **20 / 8** Minutes

Flight Rules **IFR**

Type of Flight **Scheduled**

Alternates Count **1**

Optional Entries - Automatically calculated, but can be customized

Hide Options

Scheduled Block Time **1 : 55**

Departure Runway **28L**

Arrival Runway **30R**

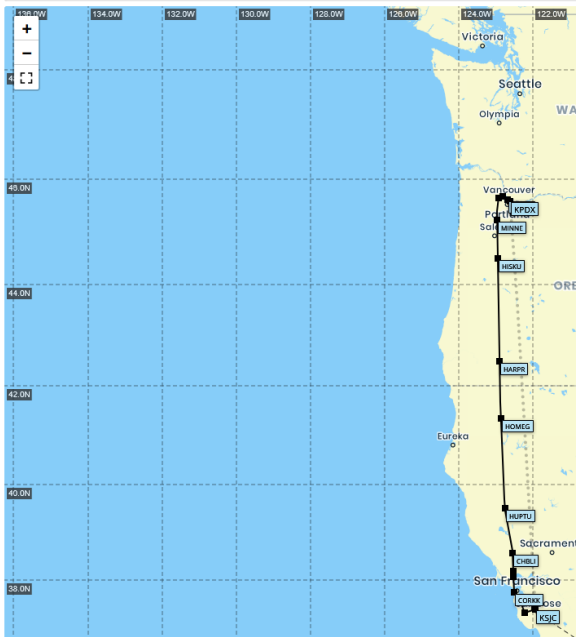
Altitude **AUTO**

Passengers **AUTO**

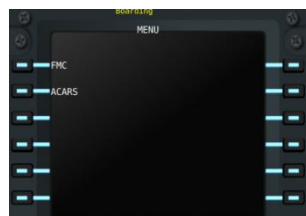
Freight **NONE**

Payload **AUTO**

Zero Fuel Weight **AUTO**

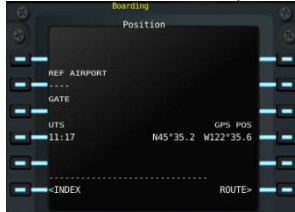


XPMC Setup



1. Select **FMC**.

- Go to **POS INIT (RSK6)** → then **ROUTE (RSK6)**.



- Enter KPDXXSJC in the console.
- Click **CO ROUTE**, then **EXE**.



- Open the **Performance Page**.
 - Enter flight level: 340 → **EXE**.

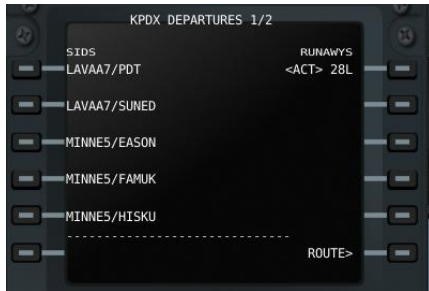


- Press **DEPARR** → **LSK1 (DEPT)**.



- Select **Runway 28L** → **EXE**.

6. Choose **SID MINNE5/HITSKU** (use **NXT PAGE**) → **EXE**.



7. Insert arrival details early (for TOD calculation).



- Destination: **KSJC**, Runway **30L**.

Select STAR **BRIXX4** transition arrival: **JILNA**, choose **ILS**, then **EXE**. (Study the arrival STAR **KSJC** see appendix)



8. Verify the **Leg List**.

- Scroll through with up/down keys.



- Ensure no **[DISCON]** messages (indicates discontinuity in route).
-

9. In the x737, set altitude dial to **34,000 ft**.



- Shortcut: type 340 in XFMC command line → click **MCP**.



10. Go to **INIT** → **TAKEOFF**.

- Enter flaps: 1 → **LSK1**.
- Set V-speeds: **V1 (RSK1)**, **V2 (RSK3)**, **Vref (RSK2)**.

11. Set flaps to **first detent**.

12. Release parking brake and taxi to **Runway 28L (KPDX)**.

☐ You are now ready for departure!

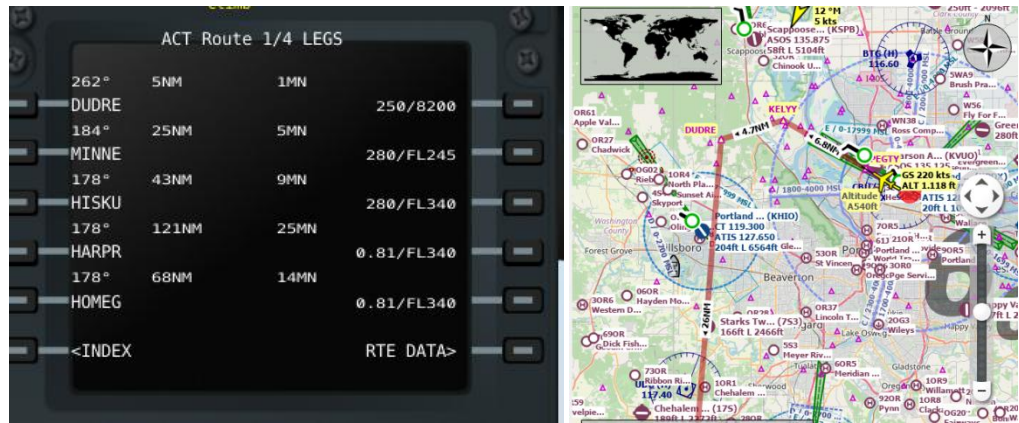
Takeoff and Climb

1. **At the holding point**

- Click on **AP XFMC** and enter **Runway 28L**.
- Align the aircraft to the centerline.
- Perform a final check — everything should be OK.
- Apply **full throttle**, keep the aircraft on the centerline.
- When XFMC displays or calls “**PULL UP**”, gently pull the joystick.
- The aircraft will lift off. Continue climbing until you see the message “**INIT CLIMB**”.
- Gently release the joystick — XFMC will take over.

2. **Neutral joystick position**

- Once the joystick is neutral, you are done for now.
- XFMC will automatically follow the **SID** and continue en route to MINNES.



3. Top of Climb (TOC)

- After around 70nm ,just after passing HISKU the aircraft will stop climbing at **34,000 ft.**
- This marks the **TOC.**
- The aircraft will then enter **cruise mode.**
- TOC can be observed in VNAV climb page



- Your x737 panel should look like this during climb .Note the AP1 and AP2 lights are **OFF**, and need to be OFF. **XFMC is running is dedicated AP mode!**



Cruise

- If you want to change the flight level:
 - Type the new FL in the XFMC command line (e.g., 360).



- Click on **MCP**.
- XFMC will then climb or descend to the new flight level.
-
- If you want to change the cruisespeed: Vnavpage Cruise: change econ speed

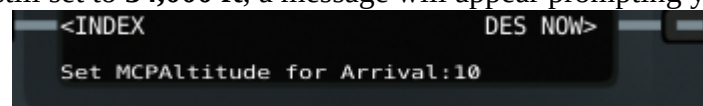


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Descent Phase

Top of Descent (TOD)

- When the **Top of Descent (TOD)** is reached, the aircraft will begin its descent.
- If the altitude is still set to **34,000 ft**, a message will appear prompting you to reset the



MCP for arrival.

- Set the MCP to **2000 ft or lower**.
- At this point, your x737 panel should look like this when the descent starts.

○

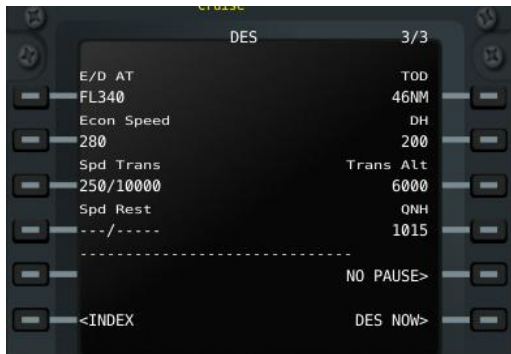


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Early Descent

- An early descent is possible within **60 NM** of TOD.

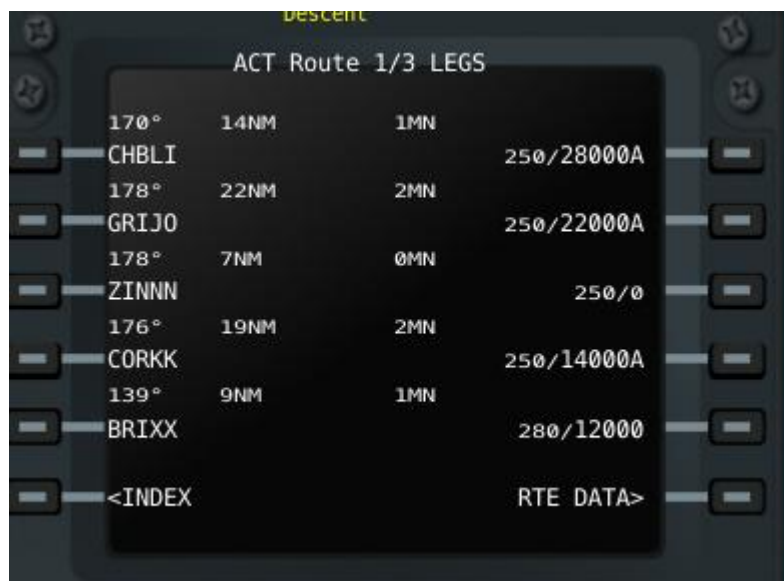
- To initiate, go to **VNAV page 3** and click **DESCENT NOW**.



- 
Descent Inhibit Logic At certain points, XFMC may temporarily halt the descent.
 - This is due to **Decision Inhibit logic**, which delays descent to prevent excessively shallow profiles.
- 
ATC Instructions
 - Normally, when **CTR** is active, the pilot reports: *"FPR ready to descend."*
 - If CTR issues instructions for a specific flight level, simply enter the flight level in the command line and click **MCP**.
- Speed Management**

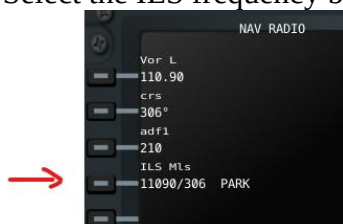
XFMC Leg List During Descent

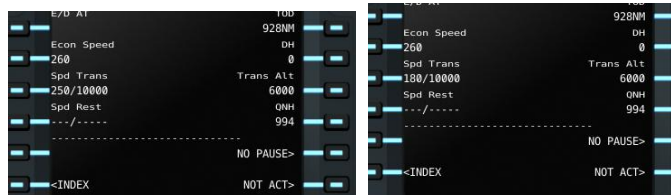
- At the first waypoint **CHBLI**, XFMC will level off at **28,000 ft**.
- Because the descent is stepped, it is recommended to reduce your speed to **260 kts**.
 - Go to **VNAV page 3** and change the **ECON Speed** to 260.
- At the STAR point **CORKK**, XFMC will level off around **14,000 ft**.
- During the STAR descent, the profile is also **stepped**: each waypoint must be crossed at a specific altitude.



-
- ACT Route 4/5 LEGS**
- | | | | |
|--------|-----|------|-----------|
| 106° | 7NM | --MN | 250/5300A |
| 85° | 1NM | --MN | 250/4700A |
| 63° | 3NM | --MN | 250/3400A |
| 63° | 2NM | --MN | 239/2800A |
| 11° | 3NM | --MN | 227/1600A |
| <INDEX | | | RTE DATA> |
- The map shows the flight path starting from YADUT (5300) and heading towards WOXAR (180K). Key waypoints and altitudes include: YADUT (5300), HEPAP (4700), FODPA (2628), JEGSA (Do not exceed 180K until WOXAR), and ARTAQ. The route is marked with distances and bearings, and the map includes geographical features like the IAF JILNA (7000) and the RNP 0.30 (RF REGD) area.

2.
 - All points match the chart, so the arrival is safe.
 - Since the approach is between mountains, extra caution is required.
 - Activate the **APP** button as soon as the aircraft turns inbound at **WOXAR**.
 - This is a **short arrival**, so reduce speed at **YADUT** (or before).
 - On the **VNAV page**, change the transition speed from 250/10000 to 180/ and confirm by clicking on the line.
3. Select the ILS frequency before entering the cone: (click on LSK4)





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4.  **Manual speed control (alternative, RECOMMENDED)**
 - Control speed manually using the throttle.
 - Disable **AHTR** on **XFMC**.
5. **Aircraft speed control (alternative)**
 - Disable **AHTR** on **XFMC**.
 - Switch **A/T ARM** ON , click **SPD** button ON



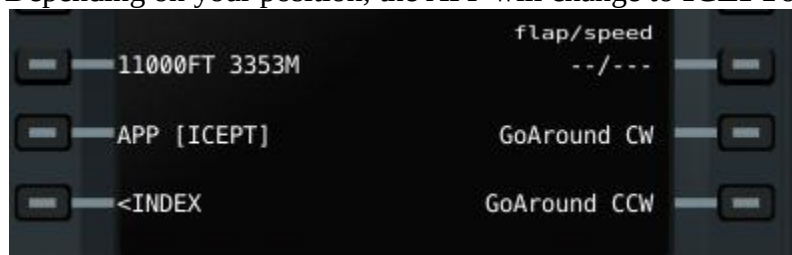
---→ At WOXAR reduce speed to 160 knots.



Arrival

1. Arrival Page

- Go to the **Arrival Page**.
- Click on the **APP** line.
- Depending on your position, the APP will change to **ICEPT** or **LLZ**.



2. LOC Beam

- If the aircraft is on the **LOC beam**, **LLZ** will be displayed.
- Wait until this changes to **GS**.



3. Glide Slope Capture

- Once **GS** is active, the aircraft will begin descending.
- Set the **first flap detent**.
- Reduce speed to **160 knots** using manual throttle, the x737, or via the VNAV page 3 (transition speed/altitude: type 160/).

4. Flaps Deployment

- Continue deploying flaps step by step until reaching **maximum flaps**.

5. Landing Gear

- At **800 ft AGL**, deploy the landing gear.

6. Decision Height (DH)

- At **200 ft AGL**, the **DH point** is reached.
- This is the last point to initiate a **go-around** if necessary.

7. Flare

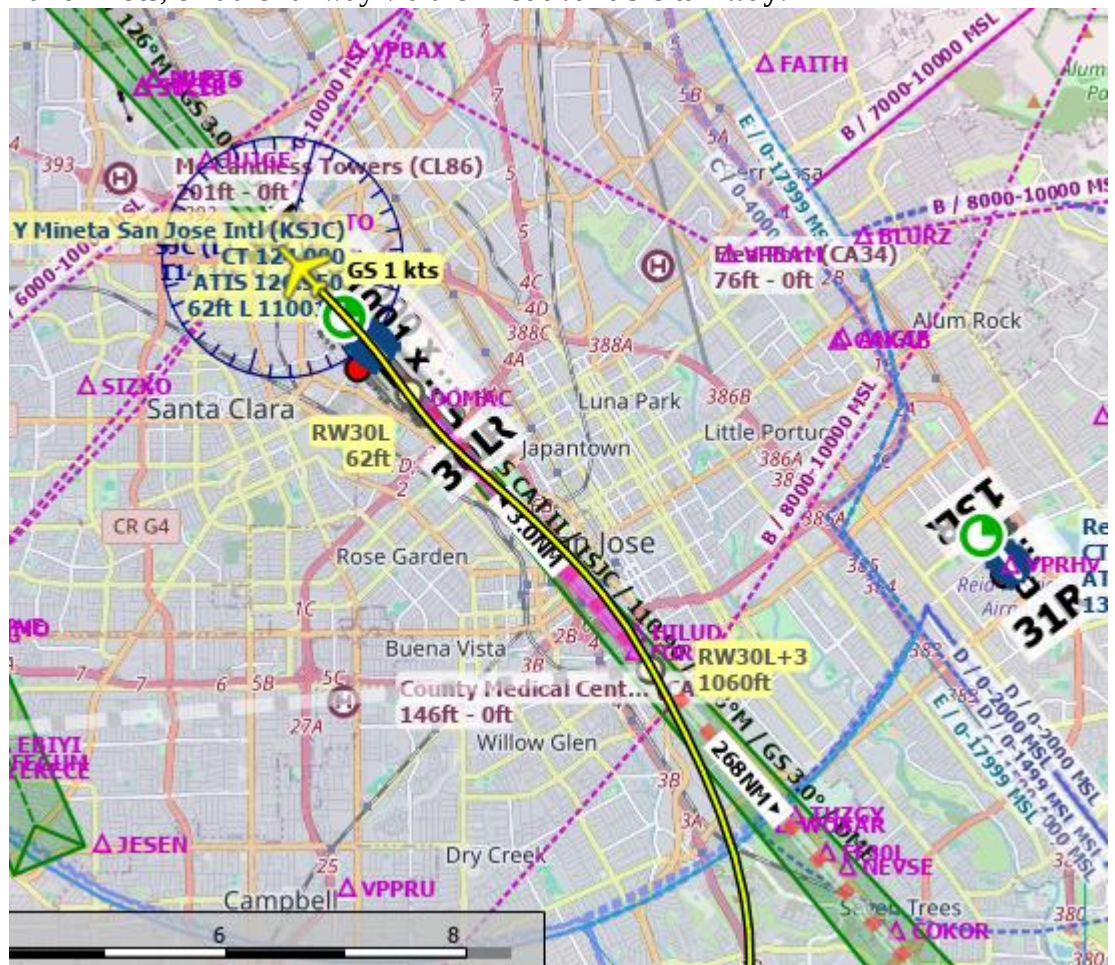
- At **30 ft AGL**, the aircraft will flare.
- Nose pitches up slightly, and the wheels make contact with the runway.

8. Braking

- Engage **reverse thrust** and apply brakes.
- Keep the nose aligned with the centerline.

9. Taxi Off Runway

- At **20 knots**, exit the runway via the **first available taxiway**.



□ You have now completed the arrival and landing sequence.!



“This arrival is considered one of the most difficult.”



Situation: When ATC Pops Up

1. **Initial Vectors** ATC will provide vectors:
 - *[FPR36]* “Turn left heading 090, descend to 8000 feet. Expect runway 12R. Reduce speed to 240.”
2. **Heading Control**
 - Disable **LNAV** on **XFMC**.
 - On the **x737**, set the heading to the assigned value.
 - Alternatively, type `HEADING/xxx` in the XFMC command line and click **FIX**.
3. **Runway and Frequency Setup**
 - On the **ARR page**, select runway **12R**.
 - Go to the **Radio page** and set the ILS frequency.
4. **Speed Management**
 - On **VNAV page 3**, enter the transition speed: `240/`.
 - Alternatively, disable **ATHR** on XFMC and set speed manually on the x737.
5. **Additional Vectors**
 - When ATC provides further vectors, follow the same procedure as above.
6. **ILS Clearance**
 - When ATC instructs: *[FPR36]* “Turn right heading 120, you are cleared for ILS approach runway 12R KSJC. Report when established on the localizer.”
 - Go to the **Arrival page**, click **APP**.
 - **ICEPT** or **LLZ** will appear.
7. **Glideslope Capture**
 - As soon as **APP [GS]** is displayed, report to ATC: *[FPR36]*

This tutorial is AI-generated, reviewed and controlled by a human

(BRXX.BRXX3) 21168

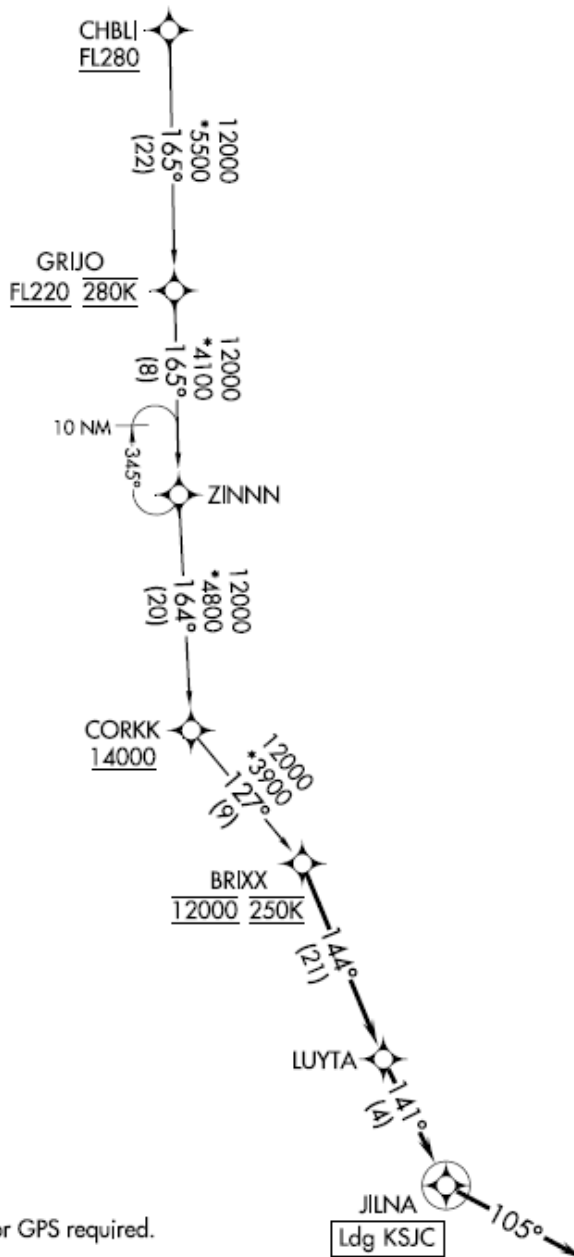
BRXX THREE ARRIVAL (RNAV)

AL-693 (FAA)

NORMAN Y MINETA SAN JOSE INTL (SJC)

SAN JOSE, CALIFORNIA

OAKLAND CENTER
125.85 323.0
NORCAL APP CON
133.95 317.6
D-ATIS
126.95
GND CON
121.7
SAN JOSE TOWER*
124.0 257.6



NOTE: RADAR required.
NOTE: RNAV 1.
NOTE: DME/DME/IRU or GPS required.

NOTE: Chart not to scale.

ARRIVAL ROUTE DESCRIPTION

SW-2, 22 FEB 2024 to 21 MAR 2024

SW-2, 22 FEB 2024 to 21 MAR 2024